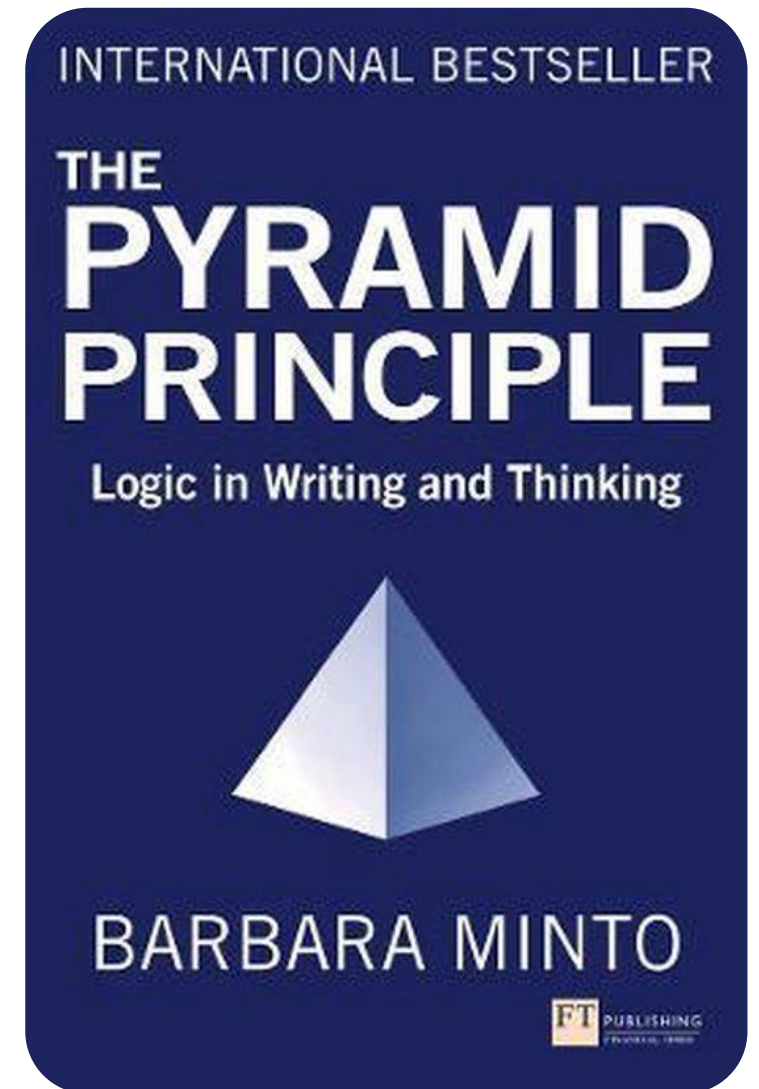


THE PYRAMID PRINCIPLE LOGIC IN WRITING AND THINKING

- Written by Barbara Minto in 1987
- She was working as a **consultant at McKinsey** at that time
- Consultants are often hired by companies to investigate and analyse (strategic) problems **and to make recommendations as neutral outsiders.**
- Consultants frequently have to persuade others to change, they do this through well structured and logical arguments that, together, **tell a convincing story**
- Minto's objective was that her colleagues **improved their (written) communication** and used more persuasive arguments
- **The Pyramid Principle** is a method to utilize lots of information and structure that in a story, message or presentations without losing the details or the power of the message



COMMUNICATE ACCORDING TO THE 'PYRAMID PRINCIPLE'



- **Situation:** Description of the topic that will resonate with the reader zijn.
- **Complication / Problem:** What is the problem you are trying to solve, what is the tension the company is feeling.
- **Question:** The question that emerge from the complication (to the point, brief and unambiguous)
- **Advice / Recommendation:** Thet 'answer' to the question posed

1

You start the communication with the 'answer'

The answer to the questions that has been posed

2

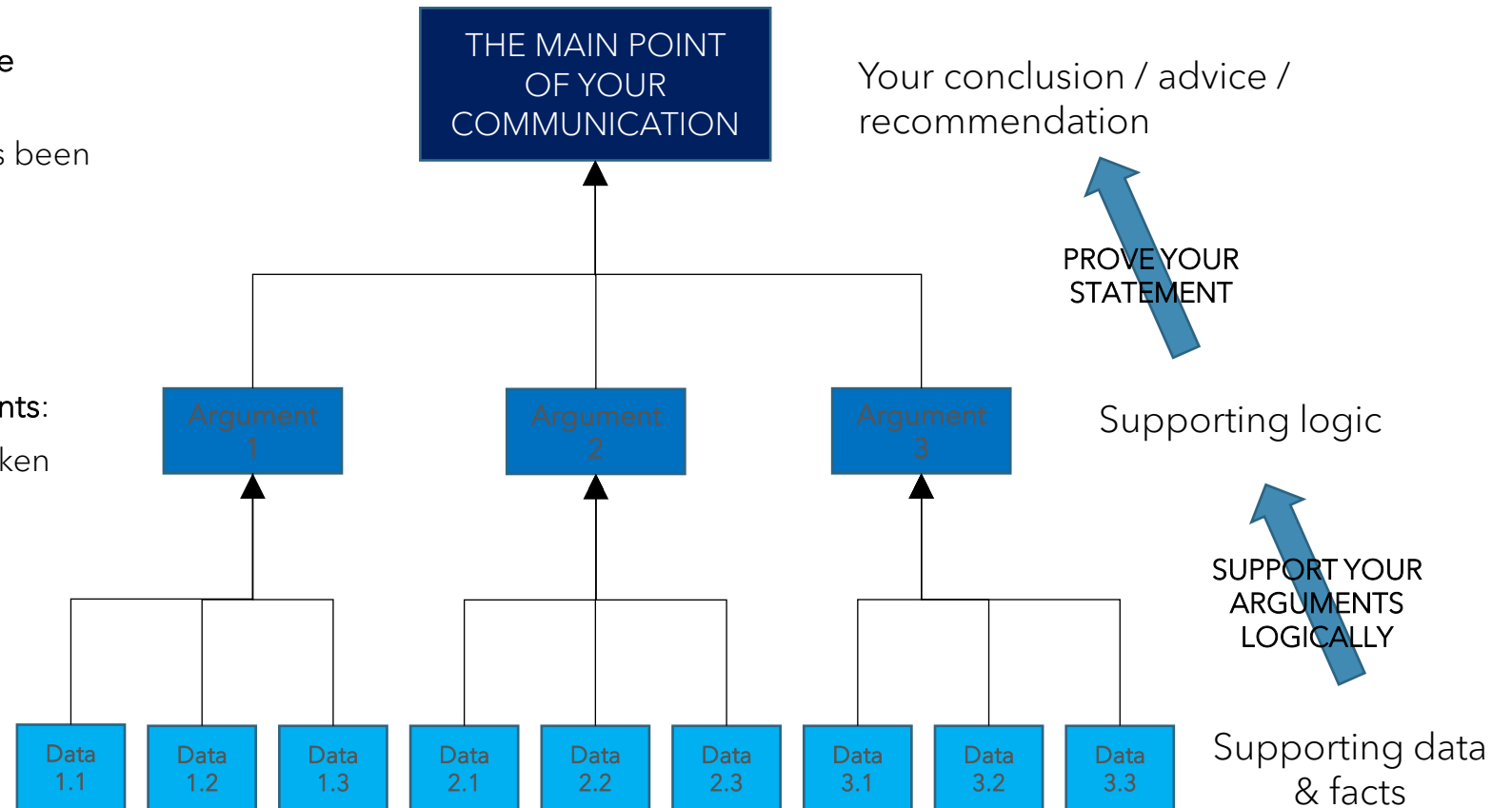
This answer is supported by arguments:

Important points (3 to max 5) that, taken together, 'prove' your answer

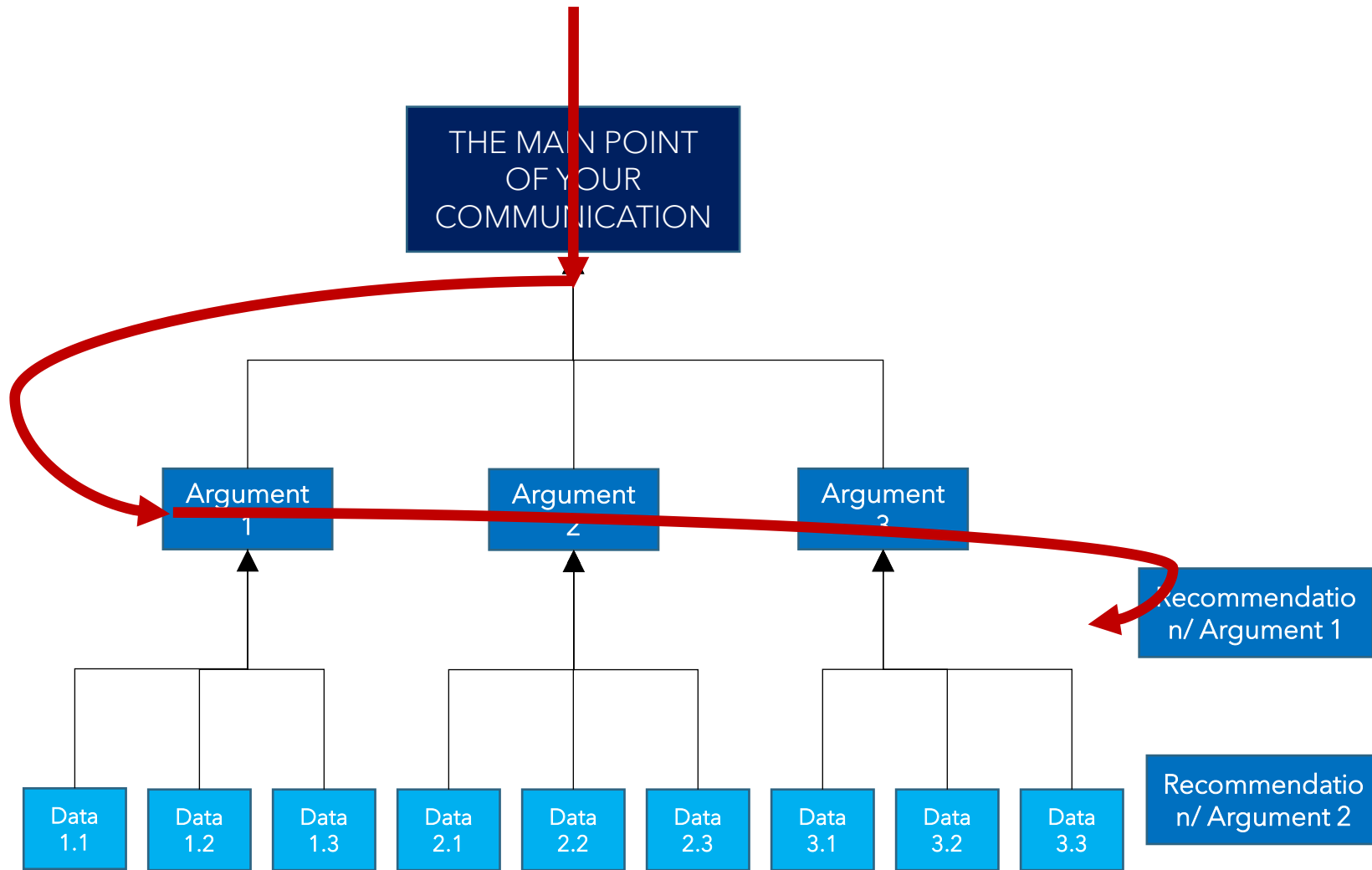
3

Each argument is supported by data / facts:

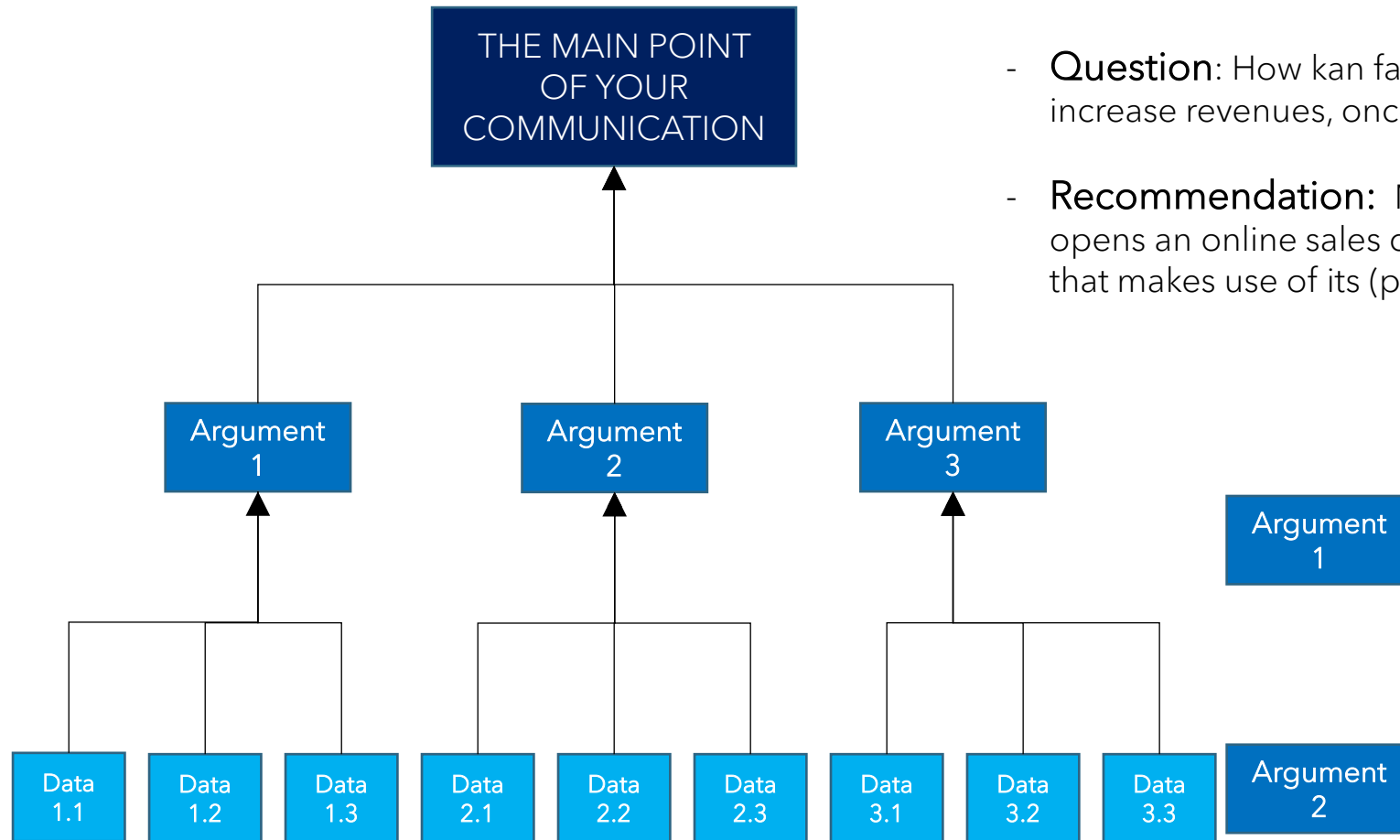
Data and fact that support / prove your arguments.



THE STORY-LINE



AN EXAMPLE



- **Situation:** Offline fashion store MKFash has managed to grow revenues consistently over the years with its highstreet locations
- **Complication / Problem:** In the last 2 years revenue growth has stalled because of Corona and customers switching online
- **Question:** How can fashion store MKFash (re) capture customers to increase revenues, once more?
- **Recommendation:** MKFash can start to grow revenues again if it opens an online sales channel and if it adopts an omni-channel strategy that makes use of its (profitable) physical stores.

MKFash should open an online sales channel

1. Customers are increasingly online (source)
2. The expectation is that online will continue to grow (source)
3. The investment to go online is not prohibitive (source)

MKFash should start to adopt an omni-channel strategy

1. Customers like choice: off- and online (source)
2. This forms a competitive advantage vs web-only shops (source)
3. A well thought out omni-channel strategy can generate efficiencies and savings (source)